

30 CHAPTERWISE IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

English Language and Literature (184) | CBSE 2026-27

The Making of a Scientist

Footprints Without Feet | Board-examinable literature

30 original revision questions with answers: short-answer, competency, assertion-reason and long-answer practice. Set is based on the current syllabus and official question-paper style; it is not a prediction or an official CBSE paper.

Question 1

Which qualities help Richard Ebright become a successful scientist?

Answer:

Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. Support from his mother and exposure to scientific material also encourage him.

Question 2

Why is the book about monarch butterflies important to Ebright?

Answer:

It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. He learns that real science requires questions, experiments, and evidence rather than collecting facts alone.

Question 3

How does Ebright respond when an early project does not succeed?

Answer:

He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question. The setback teaches him to improve his methods and think like a researcher.

Question 4

What is the central idea or skill tested in The Making of a Scientist?

Answer:

The central focus is: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. This is the starting point for a strong answer from this chapter.

Question 5

Write two relevant points for a short answer based on The Making of a Scientist.

Answer:

First point: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work.

Second point: It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. Link the two points clearly instead of listing them without explanation.

Question 6

How does the first key idea in The Making of a Scientist lead to an important result or conclusion?

Answer:

Begin with the key idea: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. Then connect it to the result: It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation.

The Making of a Scientist - Continued

Question 7

What evidence, calculation, incident or concept best supports the first main idea in The Making of a Scientist?

Answer:

Use this supporting detail: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. Support from his mother and exposure to scientific material also encourage him. The relevant detail should be stated before giving the final conclusion.

Question 8

Explain the importance of the second major idea in The Making of a Scientist.

Answer:

It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. He learns that real science requires questions, experiments, and evidence rather than collecting facts alone. Its importance lies in showing how the chapter develops the topic beyond a simple fact or definition.

Question 9

What common mistake should a student avoid while answering a question from The Making of a Scientist?

Answer:

Do not give only a conclusion. Explain the reasoning with a correct detail, such as: He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question.

Question 10

Compare the first and second important ideas in The Making of a Scientist.

Answer:

The first idea is: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. The second idea is: It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. A complete comparison states both the difference and the connection between them.

Question 11

Show a cause-and-effect link from The Making of a Scientist.

Answer:

Cause or starting point: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. Effect or outcome: It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. Use connecting words such as 'therefore', 'as a result', or 'thus'.

Question 12

What is the most useful sequence for explaining the main content of The Making of a Scientist?

Answer:

A clear sequence is: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. Next, It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. Finally, He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question.

The Making of a Scientist - Continued

Question 13

Give a 40-50 word answer outline for an important question from The Making of a Scientist.

Answer:

Start with the direct answer: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. Add one supporting point: It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. End with the outcome or message: He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question.

Question 14

How should you support an English literature answer from The Making of a Scientist?

Answer:

Use a relevant incident, character action, theme, or poetic image: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. Then explain what it reveals about the character, situation, or message.

Question 15

How can an examiner see that you understand, rather than memorise, The Making of a Scientist?

Answer:

Connect the idea to its reason or result. For instance: It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. Then explain why this point matters in the chapter's context.

Question 16

State one inference that can be drawn from the main situation or concept in The Making of a Scientist.

Answer:

A sound inference is that he studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question. This inference must be supported by a relevant point from the chapter.

Question 17

Frame a short competency-based response using the first two ideas in The Making of a Scientist.

Answer:

Apply the concept by first stating: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. Then justify the response with: It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation.

Question 18

What would make an answer from The Making of a Scientist incomplete?

Answer:

An answer is incomplete if it omits the explanation or final implication. Include both: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. Also add: He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question.

The Making of a Scientist - Continued

Question 19

Prepare an Assertion-Reason style explanation based on The Making of a Scientist.

Answer:

Assertion: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work.

Reason: It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. Check whether the reason actually explains the assertion before choosing an option.

Question 20

How should you justify an answer from The Making of a Scientist in two clear steps?

Answer:

Step 1: state the concept or event - Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. Step 2: support it with the explanation or result - It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation.

Question 21

What answer structure is suitable for a 3-mark question from The Making of a Scientist?

Answer:

Use three connected points: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question. Keep the points specific and write them in a logical order.

Question 22

What answer structure is suitable for a 5-mark question from The Making of a Scientist?

Answer:

Give an introduction, develop these key points - Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. - and close with: He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question. Add a diagram, equation, example, or textual reference where relevant.

Question 23

How can the ideas in The Making of a Scientist be applied to a new situation or case study?

Answer:

Identify the relevant principle first: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. Then use the chapter's reasoning to explain the case: It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation.

Question 24

Which detail from The Making of a Scientist is most likely to earn an extra mark when explained correctly?

Answer:

A useful detail is: He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question. Explain it in context instead of using it as an isolated statement.

The Making of a Scientist - Continued

Question 25

Write a brief concluding statement for an answer on The Making of a Scientist.

Answer:

A suitable conclusion is: He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question. This conclusion should follow naturally from the explanation rather than introduce a new point.

Question 26

Make a three-point revision note for The Making of a Scientist.

Answer:

1. Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. 2. It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. 3. He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question. Revise these points with the chapter's examples, terms, and practice questions.

Question 27

How would you self-check an answer from The Making of a Scientist before submitting it?

Answer:

Check that you have answered the exact question, used the key idea - Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. - and supported it with a reason, example, calculation, or outcome such as: It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation.

Question 28

Why does The Making of a Scientist remain important for revision?

Answer:

It combines factual recall with explanation and application. The main takeaways are: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question.

Question 29

Create a final 60-80 word answer plan for a long question from The Making of a Scientist.

Answer:

Opening: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work.

Development: It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation. Conclusion: He studies what went wrong and seeks a more meaningful question. Use complete sentences and include all required evidence, steps, or references.

Question 30

What is one last-minute revision question you should ask yourself about The Making of a Scientist?

Answer:

Ask: 'Can I explain why this is true or important?' A correct self-answer should include: Curiosity, careful observation, persistence, and willingness to test ideas guide his work. and It gives him a focused project and introduces him to scientific investigation.

Sources: CBSE English curriculum 2026-27; CBSE Class X sample papers and marking schemes 2026-27; NCERT textbooks.